

Neolokal — Executive Summary

March – May 2026 | Three-Month Programme Overview

Confidential — Ownership & Leadership Only

PART 1 — May 2026 Monthly Brief

Apr 30 – May 30, 2026 · 175 total check-ins · 5 active weeks

Overview

- 175 total check-ins across 5 active weeks
- Overall scores declined across all dimensions compared to April — but the headline averages are heavily shaped by BOH and should not be read in isolation
- FOH and BOH are telling two very different stories this month

Front of House (FOH) — Strongest month yet

- 63 responses (36% of total) — down from 82 in April and 123 in March
- FOH scores: Physical 3.32 · Mental 3.37 · Emotional 3.08 · Recovery 3.33 · Work Environment 3.65
- FOH is performing at its strongest level since the programme began
- FOH Work Environment reached 4.00 in Week 4 — the highest single dimension reading in the entire Neolokal dataset
- 67–82% of FOH low scores on physical and mental dimensions attributed to professional/work-related causes

Back of House (BOH) — Requires urgent leadership attention

- 112 responses (64% of total) — up from 107 in April
- BOH scores: Physical 1.51 · Mental 1.50 · Emotional 1.49 · Recovery 1.55 · Work Environment 1.54
- BOH is averaging near-floor scores across every single dimension
- Week of May 19–23: 78 BOH responses averaging 1.2 across all five dimensions — the most concentrated distress signal in the dataset to date
- BOH staff giving almost no reasons for their low scores — a pattern that has deepened over two months
- Wednesday and Thursday are the lowest-scoring days of the week — driven entirely by BOH

Programme Highlight — The May 8 Wellness Session

- On Friday May 8 — the team's historically hardest day of the week — BRW delivered an in-person wellness session directly on site with staff and management: meditation, breathwork, and a physical exercise using tennis balls
- The week of May 5–9 immediately following shows FOH at its strongest readings of the entire programme
- This is direct evidence that wellness integrated at work, in person, on the hardest day, produces measurable results

PART 2 — Three-Month Observations (March – May 2026)

The following observations are drawn from three full months of Daily Pulse data at Neolokal. They reflect patterns that cannot be seen in a single month's report — and are offered to support a broader strategic conversation between BRW and ownership.

Observation 1 — Participation Has Shifted Fundamentally

- March: FOH 123 (71.5%) · BOH 49 (28.5%) · Total 172
- April: FOH 82 (43.4%) · BOH 107 (56.6%) · Total 189
- May: FOH 63 (36.0%) · BOH 112 (64.0%) · Total 175
- The balance of whose voice is being heard has reversed completely. Total responses are relatively stable — but the composition has changed significantly.
- FOH has declined every single month since the programme began. This is a consistent downward trend that requires active attention from leadership.
- BOH has grown every month — a positive development that reflects increasing kitchen team engagement with the programme.

Observation 2 — FOH Has Shown Consistent Resilience

- FOH scores across three months: March 3.54–3.81 · April 3.07–3.44 · May 3.08–3.65
- FOH dipped in April and recovered in May to near-March levels — a V-shape that reflects a team that responds to support.
- FOH is the most stable and consistent signal in three months of data.
- The May 8 BRW wellness session produced the strongest FOH readings of the programme. When the programme is delivered directly at work, in person, FOH responds immediately and visibly.

Observation 3 — The BOH Trajectory Is the Defining Story of the Programme So Far

- March BOH: Physical 3.73 · Mental 3.61 · Recovery 3.61 · Work Environment 4.08 — the strongest team in the dataset
- April BOH: Physical 2.54 · Mental 2.63 · Recovery 2.59 · Work Environment 2.93 — significant drop
- May BOH: Physical 1.51 · Mental 1.50 · Recovery 1.55 · Work Environment 1.54 — near-floor across all dimensions
- This is a 2.5-point drop across every dimension over two months. It is not data noise — it is a clear, sustained, and accelerating decline.
- The BOH team went from being the highest-scoring group in March to the most distressed in May. This requires direct, honest leadership engagement.
- BOH staff are overwhelmingly not giving reasons for their low scores. The silence itself is a signal that should not be overlooked.

Observation 4 — Recovery Has Never Recovered

- March: Recovery 3.56 (all staff) · April: 2.84 · May: 2.19
- Across all three months and across both FOH and BOH, recovery has been consistently the lowest or among the lowest dimensions.
- It has not improved since the programme began. It has only declined.
- This is a structural issue — not a temporary fluctuation. How the team works, rests, and recovers between shifts is not sustainable at current levels.

- BRW recovery-focused content and practices are directly responsive to this signal and should be prioritised in the coming months.

Observation 5 — In-Person Wellness Integration Works

- On May 8, BRW delivered a direct in-person wellness session with staff and management at Neolokal: meditation, breathwork, and a physical tennis ball exercise.
- This was not owner-led. It was programme-led — BRW, on site, working directly with the team.
- FOH scores in the week immediately following were the strongest of the entire three-month programme.
- This is the clearest evidence yet that wellness integrated directly into the working day — not just available digitally — produces measurable, immediate results.
- The digital platform supports daily habit. In-person sessions create step-change moments. Both are needed.

Observation 6 — The Team Is One Ecosystem

- FOH and BOH are not two separate teams. They are one restaurant that depends on each other completely.
- This month FOH is the stronger part of that ecosystem. That strength is not a contrast to BOH's difficulties — it is an opportunity.
- The energy and morale of one part of the team can actively support the other. Today FOH is stronger. In another month, that may shift.
- Building a culture where the team lifts each other — in both directions, regardless of role — is one of the most valuable things leadership can cultivate right now.

Looking Ahead — Month 4 Trajectory

Heading into month 4, the most urgent priority is understanding and addressing the BOH situation before it deepens further. A direct, honest conversation between ownership and the kitchen team — supported by BRW — is the most important next step. If the May 8 effect holds as a model, continued in-person BRW engagement combined with active programme integration offers the clearest path to recovery for the whole team.